

Sales Training — Session 40

Deals, Not Dials.

Two a Day Is the Measurement. Everything Else Is Guidance.

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WHAT THIS SESSION IS A reframe of what reps should actually be measuring — and why the daily call target that most sales teams obsess over is a guide, not a goal. Two deals a day is the measurement. Everything upstream of that — the calls, the tone, the falcon-eye view of your own performance — is in service of getting to two. This session covers that reframe, the daily discipline that supports it, and the longer-horizon thinking that turns two-a-day into a career.

1. The 70-call trap

Every sales team runs on a daily call target. In this room the number is 70. It's the number reps get anxious about missing, the number they mentally track through the day, the number that shapes whether they think they've had a good afternoon or a bad one. The session opened with a direct challenge to that framing. The 70-call number is a guide — not a goal. If a rep hits 70 calls and gets zero bookings, they've had a bad day. If a rep hits 20 calls and gets seven bookings, they've had a spectacular one. The measurement is the bookings, not the dials.

This matters because the wrong measurement produces the wrong behaviour. A rep who fixates on the 70 starts padding calls — dialling faster, staying on the line shorter, treating each call as a box to tick rather than a conversation to run properly. Their tone tightens. Their listening degrades. Their close rate collapses. They hit 70. They get nothing. And they can't figure out why, because by their scoreboard, they did their job.

"The 70 calls is just a number. You don't get paid on how many calls you did. You get paid on the deals. Focus there. Everything else is guidance."

2. Commission breath — from over-dialling this time

A specific failure mode of call-count obsession, worth naming. Reps who feel behind on their call count start rushing. That rush produces a phenomenon that's appeared in earlier sessions under a different cause: commission breath. The buyer hears the pace, senses the urgency behind it, and instinctively pulls back. The rep speeds up further to compensate. The whole call is now controlled by the rep's anxiety about their own metric, not by the actual conversation.

The corrective is counterintuitive: sometimes doing FEWER calls produces more deals. A rep who takes their time on each call, listens properly, adjusts their pitch to the buyer, closes hard when the signal is there — that rep is running 40 quality calls a day and closing three. A rep who's chasing 70 is running 70 rushed conversations and closing one. The scoreboard says the second rep worked harder. The bank account says the first rep won.

"You develop commission breath when you're chasing the number instead of the deal. The buyer hears it. Slow down. Do fewer calls better. Two deals will find you."

3. If you're stuck — walk. Punch a tree.

A specific piece of practical advice for the moments when nothing's working. Some days, the calls are flat, the buyers are hostile, the rep can feel themselves getting worse call by call as the frustration compounds. The instinct is to grind through — dial more, push harder, tell themselves they'll snap out of it. That instinct almost always makes it worse. The mind is looping, and the loop tightens with every additional call.

The fix is to break the loop physically. Stand up. Walk out of the office. Get a coffee. Punch a tree — not literally, but the point is: introduce a strong physical circuit-breaker that interrupts the mental spiral. Ten minutes away from the desk resets the falcon (see Section 5). The rep who comes back after that ten minutes is functionally a different rep. The rep who stayed and grinded is still the same rep who was struggling — just more tired.

"If it's not working, walk. Get a breather. Clear your head. Just ramming your head into the wall doesn't work — the wall wins every time."

4. The call scorecard — sneak up and grade

A practical tool for team leaders and senior reps. Everyone's call quality varies day to day, but nobody has a clear picture of their own patterns because nobody's observing themselves from outside. The move: build a simple scorecard with the attributes that make a great call — confidence, product knowledge, certainty, tonality, humour, pacing, listening — and quietly observe teammates' calls, grading each attribute out of ten.

The delivery matters. Corie's instruction: sidle in. Don't stand behind the rep with a clipboard — that puts them off, changes their behaviour, and defeats the point. Casually be in the room. Overhear. Note down. Provide constructive feedback later, when the rep isn't in performance mode. Over a week or two, patterns emerge. Every rep has one. Sometimes they're winning patterns worth doubling down on. Sometimes they're losing patterns worth breaking. The pattern only becomes visible when someone else is watching for it.

"There's always a pattern. Whether you're winning or losing, there's a pattern. The problem is if you've got no self-awareness, you never see it — so someone else has to see it for you."

The corollary: most reps, when they see their own pattern, still resist changing it. Change is where the money is — and change is uncomfortable. The reps who use their scorecards to actually adjust behaviour are the reps who compound. The reps who look at their scorecards and nod and change nothing stay exactly where they are.

5. The falcon — listen to yourself from above

Corie's central mental model for what "self-awareness" actually looks like in practice. Picture a falcon perched on your shoulder. During any call, the falcon lifts off, hovers ten metres above the room, and watches. From that vantage point, the falcon can see the rep AND the buyer AND the conversation AND the tone in the room, all at once. The falcon reports back to the rep in real time: "you're going too fast," "the buyer is disengaging," "try a different question," "you've got them — close now."

Reps who never send the falcon up are trapped inside the call. They can hear their own voice and the buyer's response but not the actual dynamic between them. Reps who consistently deploy the falcon are running a higher-quality conversation because they have real-time feedback on how the call is actually landing — not just how they think it's landing from inside their own head.

"Send the falcon up. Listen to yourself. Listen to the client. Match their energy. That's the difference between a call that closes and a call that just happens."

Practical drill: at the start of every call, mentally place the falcon overhead. Every 60 seconds, check what the falcon is seeing. If the falcon disappears mid-call — the rep has been absorbed into the conversation and lost the perspective — bring it back. Over time this becomes automatic. Reps who develop this habit report material improvements in close rate that they can't attribute to any specific script change; the change is in the meta-awareness, not in what they're saying.

6. Match the energy — loud versus classical music

A tonal discipline that flows directly out of the falcon. Different buyers want different call energies. Some buyers want warmth, humour, and pace — jack the volume up. Some buyers want quiet, professional, precise information — bring it down to classical-music level. The rep who plays the same track for every buyer is missing half the calls. Loud energy on a buyer who wanted classical is jarring; classical energy on a buyer who wanted loud is boring. Both lose the deal.

"Classical music has to be played gently while people are studying. You can't blast it. But some buyers you can crank the volume up on — they want that. Read the room. Adjust the volume. Every buyer, every call."

The falcon is the tool that tells the rep which mode this specific buyer wants. Listen for the buyer's own tone in the first thirty seconds. If they're crisp and businesslike, drop the humour. If they're warm and chatty, lean in. This isn't manipulation — it's respect. The rep is meeting the buyer in the tonal register the buyer chose. Buyers feel it, even if they can't articulate it.

7. Productive versus unproductive — the only two categories

Corie's personal daily classification. He doesn't ask himself whether the day was good or bad. Good/bad is a mood judgement; it depends on how he happens to feel at 6pm. Instead

he asks: was today productive, or unproductive? Did I move something forward, or didn't I? Two categories. Binary. Applied at the end of every day.

Crucially, a productive day doesn't require a deal. A day where the rep learned something valuable that they can apply tomorrow is productive. A day where the rep identified a specific weakness in their pitch is productive. A day where the rep booked no meetings but had two conversations that will convert next week is productive. The measurement is forward motion — not immediate outcomes. Reps who classify their days this way have more resilient careers because they can string together productive days even when the deals aren't landing yet.

"Productive or unproductive. Two categories. That's it. Good or bad depends on my mood. Productive or unproductive depends on whether the day moved something. That's the measurement."

8. Stacking — how careers actually compound

The daily verb Corie uses for what a productive day produces. Stacking. Every productive day, the rep adds one small thing to their kit — a new objection response, a new tonal move, a new observation about how a specific kind of buyer behaves. None of those additions transforms the rep on their own. Two thousand of them — accumulated over years of stacking — produce a rep who looks completely different from where they started.

The reps who stack are the reps who compound. The reps who don't stack — who treat each day as its own isolated event, without capturing what worked or what didn't — run in place for a decade and wonder why the more junior rep next to them just overtook them. Stacking is invisible day to day. It's obvious at the two-year mark. It's the entire difference between an average career and a great one.

"Stack every day. One thing. It's like termites — nibble, nibble, nibble. Eventually the house comes down. But you have to keep nibbling every day."

9. The deadline reframe — 36 years and counting

A macro-timeline argument that anchored the whole session. A 24-year-old rep has, statistically, 60-plus years of life ahead of them. Feels like an eternity — the standard assumption is that there's plenty of time to figure things out, drift for a while, get serious later. That assumption is wrong. Retirement, by choice, requires a working career of maybe 36 more years for that rep. 36 years to build a life worth retiring on.

36 years feels long from inside the moment. It isn't. Ask any 44-year-old what happened to the 20 years between them and their 24-year-old self — the answer is "I don't know, they went past." The rep at 24 has the same amount of time-perception ahead of them. If they don't structure it deliberately, it goes past too. The reframe isn't morbid; it's the opposite. Every day is a gift. That's why it's called the present. But it's a gift with a countdown attached.

"You're on a deadline. Nobody knows when it lands. That's not morbid — it's an appreciation. Every day is a gift. Don't waste them running the wrong metric."

10. Start at the end — what do you want to OWN

A question Corie treats as diagnostic. When someone tells him they want a career, he's not interested — "career" is a fuzzy word that means nothing operational. He wants to know what they want to OWN. What car, what house, what lifestyle, what set of options. Own is concrete. Own is measurable. Own tells the rep how much money they need to earn, over what timeline, to arrive at the life they said they wanted.

The move — for every rep — is to start at the end. Picture the life you want at 60. Get specific. What does it look like? Where do you live? What do you drive? Who are you having dinner with? What are you free to do on a Tuesday morning? Then work backwards. What income does that life require? What's the runway to build it? What does the rep need to be doing at 24 to be on track for 60? The daily calls stop being the measurement. The end-state does. The calls become instruments in service of the end-state, not the point of it.

"Everything in life starts at the end. What do you want to own? Not 'a career.' What do you want to OWN? That's the question that tells you what to do tomorrow."

11. The inner child doesn't change — skills stack on top

An observation that most people don't articulate but recognise immediately when it's named. Corie's claim: the internal version of yourself — the person you talk to in the mirror, the voice inside your head, the you that walks around your house making tea — doesn't really change across a lifetime. That person at 16 is the same person at 44. What changes is the layer of skills, experience, and financial capacity that gets stacked on top.

Two implications. First, don't wait to feel different before you start acting different. The 44-year-old rep won't feel more grown-up than the 24-year-old rep — they'll just have more skills. The skill stack is what changes; the internal person doesn't. Second, the 16-year-old inside every rep is a resource, not a problem. The 16-year-old is playful, imaginative, willing to try weird things without worrying about looking stupid. Reps who stay connected to that 16-year-old take the risks that produce the careers. Reps who bury the 16-year-old under a layer of adult seriousness end up cautious and ordinary.

"There's no gap between my 16-year-old self and my 44-year-old self. Same person. The only difference is skills stacked on top — and financial capacity to do the weird things the 16-year-old wanted to do."

12. Blind faith, manifestation, and the vision board

The mental-model layer beneath the tactical work. Corie's phrase — "blind faith" — is the willingness to commit to a version of the future you can't yet see the path to. Reps who require a fully-visible path before they start work never start. Reps who commit to the destination and trust that the path will emerge as they walk make careers.

Manifestation, in the operational sense the session uses it, isn't magic. It's the discipline of repeatedly picturing the specific outcome you want — vividly, in enough detail that it feels real — until the daily behaviour reorganises itself around producing that outcome. Corie's example: eight years ago he built a vision board with a boat, three kids running on a beach, and a specific style of house. He looks at the board every day. Today he owns the boat, has three kids, and his house is architecturally almost identical to the one on the board. The board didn't cause the outcome directly — the daily behaviour caused the outcome. The board caused the daily behaviour.

"Manifestation is real, but not the way people talk about it. It's not magic — it's you obsessed over the outcome long enough that your daily habits reorganise around producing it. The board is the reminder. The habits are the work."

Practical action: every rep should build their own vision board — physical or digital — with specific images of the life they want. Not a career slogan. Not a mood board. Actual pictures of the actual things. Look at it every day. Notice what happens to daily choices over three months. Reps who do this consistently report their behaviour drifts, unconsciously, in the direction of the board.

13. Front-run your own growth

A specific instruction for reps who want to move up. If the rep wants to be managing a team of five in two years, they need to be doing manager-level behaviour NOW, not when the title arrives. The title follows the behaviour, not the other way around. Reps who wait for the promotion before they start showing up like a manager wait forever. Reps who show up like a manager already are the ones who get promoted — usually earlier than they expected.

Corie's Lucas story illustrates the principle from the manager's side. Years ago Corie was the only salesperson in the company. He gave Lucas every sales responsibility overnight — before Lucas was ready — because Lucas needed to feel the weight of the role to become someone who could carry it. Lucas was terrible at first. Corie described it as "atrocious." Six months later Lucas was closing consistently. The gap between "not ready" and "can do it" was six months of being thrown into the role. Waiting until Lucas was "ready" would have taken years — and might never have happened.

"You have to have faith. Throw them into it. Let them fall over. Be there to pick them up. Score them up. That's how people become what they're going to be."

Applied to any rep on the floor: identify the role you want to be in two years. Identify one behaviour that role requires that you're not doing yet. Start doing it this week. Don't wait for permission. The behaviour is what earns the permission, not the other way around.

14. Action items for the team

1. Reframe your daily target: two deals is the measurement. The 70 calls is guidance. If you hit 20 and close three, the day is a win.

2. If you catch yourself dialling faster because you're behind on calls — STOP. Slow down. That's commission breath. Fewer, better calls close more deals.
3. When you feel stuck mid-day, physically leave the desk for 10 minutes. Walk. Water. Reset. Come back different. Don't grind through — grinding through wins nothing.
4. Build the call scorecard (confidence, product knowledge, certainty, tonality, humour, pacing, listening). Sneak up on teammates and grade quietly. Share feedback later, not in the moment.
5. At the start of every call, mentally place the falcon overhead. Every 60 seconds, check what it's seeing. If it disappears, bring it back.
6. Classify every day at 6pm as productive or unproductive. Two categories. String productive days together — that's how careers actually compound.
7. End every productive day by stacking one thing — a new line, a new observation, a new pattern noticed. Log it. Two thousand of these over a career is the whole game.
8. Answer the question "what do I want to OWN by 60?" in specific detail. Not a career. Things you can point to. Work backwards from there to what you need to be doing now.
9. Build a vision board this week. Physical or digital. Specific images. Look at it daily. Watch what happens to your choices over three months.
10. Front-run your own growth. Identify one behaviour the role you want in two years requires — and start doing it this week. Don't wait for permission.

THE RULE OF THUMB Two deals a day is the measurement. Everything upstream — the calls, the tone, the falcon overhead — is in service of getting to two. Don't grind harder on the wrong metric. Start at the end. Stack every day. Blind faith in the destination + Wolverine execution on the daily habits = the career you're actually here to build.